PaySlate Dependencies — Why Each Package Earns Its Place

> A justified inventory of every package in `pubspec.yaml` — what it does, why it's here, and how it fits into the clean-architecture migration.

The source of truth for **versions** is `pubspec.yaml`. This document is the source of truth for **rationale**: when a future contributor asks *"do we really need this package?"*, the answer should be findable here.

> 📐 **Rule of thumb:** if a package can't be justified in one line, it probably shouldn't be in `pubspec.yaml`.

Runtime Dependencies

State Management

Package	Why
`provider: ^6.0.5`	Current state container (ChangeNotifier-based). **Being phased out** in favor of Cubit/Bloc on each feature's `presentation/cubit/`. Keep until last migrated feature is moved.

Navigation

Package	Why
`go_router: ^14.6.0`	Declarative URL-based routing. Pairs with the routing-redirect layer that translates server `RedirectAction` payloads into navigation.

Networking

Package	Why
`http: ^1.2.1`	Legacy direct calls in `lib/services/api_services.dart`. Being replaced by a Dio-based `ApiClient` in `core/network/`.

`http_parser: ^4.0.2`	Multipart/form-data helpers for file uploads (used by `image_picker` flows).
`connectivity_plus: ^6.1.0`	Powers `NetworkInfo` — repositories use this to decide remote-vs-local data sources.

Storage

Package	Why
`shared_preferences: ^2.0.0`	Primitives: tokens, flags, last-route, feature flags.
`isar: ^3.1.0+1`	New object-relational store for entries, books, accounts. **Replaces Hive.** Supports indexed queries and async transactions.
`isar_flutter_libs: ^3.1.0+1`	Platform binaries for Isar.

Architecture / DI

Package	Why
`get_it: ^7.6.0`	Service locator for use cases, repositories, datasources. Registered in `app_bootstrap.dart`.
`dartz: ^0.10.1`	`Either<Failure, T>` return type for use cases and repositories.

Auth

Package	Why
`local_auth: ^2.1.7`	Biometric unlock (Face ID / Touch ID / fingerprint) on the MPIN screen.

UI

Package	Why
`flutter_svg: ^2.2.1`	SVG icon rendering (category icons, asset constants).
`auto_size_text: ^3.0.0`	Long book / entry names that need to shrink to fit.

`pinput: ^5.0.0`	OTP and MPIN entry.
`sticky_grouped_list: ^3.1.0`	Date-grouped entry lists with sticky headers.
`fluttertoast: ^8.0.9`	Lightweight feedback toasts.
`shimmer: ^3.0.0`	Skeleton loaders.
`keyboard_height_plugin: ^0.1.5`	Keeps the keyboard-aware bottom-sheets behaving correctly across platforms.
`fl_chart: ^0.65.0`	Pie / line charts in analytics views.
`material_symbols_icons: ^4.2867.0`	Material Symbols icon font.

Media

Package	Why
`image: ^4.2.0`	Image manipulation pipeline.
`image_picker: ^1.0.2`	Pick photos from camera / gallery for entry attachments.
`image_cropper: ^8.1.0`	Crop attachment images before upload.
`flutter_image_compress: ^2.3.0`	Compress images so uploads stay small.
`cached_network_image: ^3.2.3`	Cache remote thumbnails (attachments).
`flutter_cache_manager: ^3.0.0`	Underlies `cached_network_image`; also used for PDF/Excel temp files.

Files

Package	Why
`file_picker: ^8.1.6`	Attach non-image files to entries.
`open_file: ^3.5.10`	Open downloaded PDF/Excel exports.
`path: ^1.6.0`, `path_provider: ^2.0.5`	App-specific directories for caches and exports.

Export

Package	Why
`pdf: ^3.11.0`	Generate PDF account statements.
`excel: ^4.0.6`	Generate Excel exports.

Currency / I18n

Package	Why
`currency_picker: ^2.0.21`	Currency-symbol picker for new books.
`currency_converter: ^2.0.0`	Cross-currency display helpers.
`intl: ^0.18.0`	Date / number formatting.

Device

Package	Why
`device_info_plus: ^11.2.0`	Identify device for force-update + analytics.
`package_info_plus: ^8.1.2`	App version (drives force-update comparisons).
`permission_handler: ^11.3.1`	Camera, photo, contacts, notification permission requests.
`url_launcher: ^6.3.1`	Open external URLs (terms, privacy, support email).

Logging

Package	Why
`logger: ^2.5.0`	Structured app-wide logging with levels.

WebSocket

Package	Why
`stomp_dart_client: ^2.0.0`	Real-time entry updates via STOMP over WebSocket.

Firebase

Package	Why
`firebase_core: ^3.8.1`	Required base for any Firebase usage.
`firebase_messaging: ^15.1.6`	FCM push notifications.
`flutter_local_notifications: ^18.0.1`	Render notifications on Android when the app is in foreground.

Contacts

Package	Why
`flutter_contacts: ^1.1.9+2`	Phone contact picker for vendor/customer selection.

Dev Dependencies

Package	Why
`flutter_test`	Bundled Flutter widget/unit test harness.
`mocktail: ^1.0.0`	Mocks without codegen. **Preferred over Mockito** for new tests.
`build_runner: ^2.3.3`	Drives code generation for Isar + json_serializable.
`isar_generator: ^3.1.0+1`	Generates Isar schema adapters.
`json_annotation: ^4.9.0`	Annotations for `json_serializable`.
`json_serializable: ^6.0.0`	DTO `fromJson` / `toJson` codegen.
`flutter_lints: ^5.0.0`	Lint rules.
`flutter_launcher_icons: ^0.14.2`	Generates platform launcher icons from `assets/icon/app_icon.png`.
`flutter_flavorizr: ^2.2.3`	Scaffolds per-flavor configuration (used to generate the dev/staging/production setup).
`firebase_core_platform_interface: ^6.0.3`	Test-time interface for mocking Firebase.

Adding a New Package

Before introducing a new dependency, walk this checklist:

1. Add it to `pubspec.yaml` **under the correct section** (state / UI / media / etc).
2. Run `flutter pub get`.
3. Add a one-line *"Why"* entry to this doc — if you can't justify it in one line, **reconsider the dependency**.
4. If it bundles native code (anything with a `_platform_interface`), test on **both iOS and Android** before merging.

> 🚦 Every new package adds binary size, build time, and security surface. Bias toward "no" — and toward removing one when you add one.